

are bargain hunters. By nature they are frugal.”

For those survey respondents who said their Groupon campaigns had not been profitable, only 25 percent of the redeemers of their offers spent more than the face value of the coupon, and only 13 percent came back a second time to shop full price.

Sorry guys, that is standard operating procedure for most of the couponers I know. We’ll be happy to spend ten dollars on a forty-dollar value, but we’re not going to spend more than that if we can help it, and we certainly aren’t likely to come back and spend forty dollars for something we’d just gotten for ten dollars, unless it is something we desperately need and can’t find elsewhere for less. And even then, we’d rather do without it than pay full price.

Marketers would do well to figure this out, because it looks like frugality is the new standard. According to an October 2009 online survey conducted by Booz & Company, a leading global management consulting firm, a “new frugality” was born of the Great Recession. Their survey of 2000 US consumers suggested that an increased frugality may have become learned behavior, making American consumers a more discerning type of consumer.

“Frugal behavior is now considered trendy by many shoppers, and will continue for years to come,” said Matt Egol, a partner in Booz & Company.

Another study by Booz & Company in collaboration with Grocery Manufacturers Association, the *Shopper Marketing 3.0*, found shoppers conducting research before they shopped, with a focus on finding the best prices, clipping coupons, and reading circulars for what is on sale.